IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 15, 2026

Record Territory

SPY cleared the major resistance zone at $691.90-$693.20 on Tuesday's 1.22% rally, placing the index within striking distance of the January all-time high as PPI came in well below consensus.

SPY	BRENT CRUDE	GOLD	BITCOIN	FEAR & GREED
$694.46 ↑1.22%	~$95 ↓3%	~$4,895 ↑2.23%	~$74,000 ↑1.3%	23 · Improving

SECTION 01

Markets

BREAKOUT CONFIRMED — INDEX WITHIN STRIKING DISTANCE OF ALL-TIME HIGH

Tuesday's session delivered a clean breakout. The S&P 500 rose 1.22%, the Nasdaq surged 1.82%, the Dow gained 0.70%, and the Russell 2000 added 1.38%. UVXY fell 2.05% as volatility compression continued. Discretionary (+2.21%), tech (+1.60%), and communications services (+1.52%) led sectors. Energy was the clear laggard at −2.03% as crude gave back prior-session gains. The index is now within approximately seven points of the January 28 all-time high at 7,002.28, with S&P futures hovering near 7,005 in the premarket per TheStreet. The confluence of catalysts was unusually favorable: a soft PPI print, strong Citigroup earnings, resumed US-Iran negotiation signals, and oil retreating 3–4% all combined to drive the advance. The question today is whether the tape can clear the January high on the open or whether another session of consolidation is required.

CARSON'S TECHNICAL FRAMEWORK — MAJOR RESISTANCE ZONE CLEARED, ALL RESISTANCE NOW IN THE REARVIEW

Tuesday's rally took SPY through Carson's major resistance zone at $691.90-$693.20 on a single session. The intraday print of $694.58 cleared both bounds, and the close at $694.46 settled above the zone. Both levels are marked hit on the technical register. Carson's working view had anticipated a meaningful concentration of sell-side order flow at this band but allowed for a sustained breakout; the breakout has materialized. With all near-term resistance now cleared, the upside objective on the framework shifts toward the January all-time high of approximately 7,002 on the S&P 500 index (equivalent to roughly $700 on SPY). On the downside, the published support at $645.80 remains untouched and intact as the retracement anchor should the breakout reverse.

SUPPORT	SPY $645.80 · Retracement target · ACTIVE (untouched)
RESISTANCE (MAJOR)	SPY $691.90–$693.20 · HIT on April 14 at $694.58 · Cleared
RESISTANCE (INTERMEDIATE)	SPY $683.70 / $685.85 · HIT on April 13 · Cleared
NEXT REFERENCE	January all-time high ~7,002 (S&P index) · ~$700 SPY

PPI +0.5% VS 1.1% CONSENSUS — THE STAGFLATION PRESSURE HAS SOFTENED

Tuesday's March PPI release was the single most important macro data point of the month. Headline PPI rose just 0.5% month-over-month against the 1.1% consensus estimate, with annual pricing up 4.0%—the largest 12-month advance since

February 2023 but well below feared levels, according to the BLS. Core PPI, excluding food and energy, rose only 0.1% versus the 0.5% estimate. Energy drove the headline: gasoline prices surged 15.7%, diesel jumped 42%, and jet fuel rose 30.7%, collectively accounting for roughly half the gain. Services prices were flat. The message is clear: the war's energy shock is pushing through to headline inflation but has not broadened into core pricing pressure. For the Fed, this is the most constructive possible combination—hot headline that justifies the current hold posture, soft core that preserves the option for eventual easing. The zero-cut baseline for 2026 remains intact but the probability of further tightening has meaningfully declined.

Q1 BANK EARNINGS — CITI LEADS, JPM BEATS BUT NII GUIDANCE WEIGHS

The bank reporting cycle opened with mixed but broadly constructive results. JPMorgan posted adjusted EPS of $5.94 versus the $5.46 consensus, driven by record quarterly trading revenue of $11.6 billion (+20% year-over-year), but the bank trimmed 2026 net interest income guidance to $103 billion from $104.5 billion, and shares declined approximately 3%. Citigroup significantly outpaced estimates with services revenue of $6.1 billion (+17% year-over-year), banking revenue up 15%, and equity underwriting fees surging 64%, establishing the bank as the quarter's top performer among money-centers. Wells Fargo delivered in-line results ($1.60 vs $1.60 consensus) but softened its NII guidance, which shifted its valuation narrative. JNJ reported $2.70 versus the $2.69 estimate, an essentially in-line print. The bank tape reflects the broader macro read: operating businesses are strong, but the path of net interest margins remains constrained by the flat yield curve and the Fed's indefinite hold.

SPY	$694.46 · ↑1.22% · Futures ~$700 Wed AM
MARCH PPI	+0.5% MoM vs 1.1% est · Core +0.1% vs 0.5% est
JPM	$5.94 adj vs $5.46 est · BEAT · Stock ↓3% on NII cut
CITIGROUP	Strong beat · Services +17% · Equity underwriting +64%
EMPIRE STATE MFG	11 vs −0.5 est · Major beat
FEAR & GREED	23 · Up from April 13's 21

The breakout materialized on the day the macro delivered the most favorable configuration possible: soft PPI, strong bank earnings, resumed negotiation signals, and oil retreating. Tuesday was the first session of the war where every major catalyst aligned in the same direction. The tape responded accordingly. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

Geopolitics

SECOND ROUND OF TALKS — BOTH SIDES PROPOSING ENRICHMENT SUSPENSION

The US and Iran are arranging a second round of ceasefire talks ahead of the April 21 expiration of the existing framework, according to Bloomberg. Both sides have now proposed a suspension of Iranian uranium enrichment, with the sticking point reduced to the timeframe rather than the concept. The US continues to demand the dismantling of Iran's major enrichment facilities and the immediate reopening of the Strait of Hormuz; Tehran considers the ongoing US naval blockade a violation of the ceasefire. The narrowing of substantive gaps is the most constructive diplomatic development since the original 15-point plan was rejected in late March. If a framework extension materializes before April 21, oil could continue its retreat and the equity rally likely extends; if the window expires without an extension, the energy and defense premiums reassert.

THE BLOCKADE IS FULLY IMPLEMENTED — OIL CONTINUES TO RETREAT

CENTCOM confirmed the naval blockade is fully implemented and has completely halted economic trade through Iranian ports, according to Al Jazeera. Few ships have transited the Strait since the blockade began on April 13. However, the operation's practical supply impact appears limited given that Hormuz transit had already been substantially disrupted under Iran's selective-access regime established in March. Oil has responded: Brent fell approximately 3% on Tuesday to $95 and WTI dropped 3.60%, reflecting market pricing of the renewed negotiation track rather than the blockade's enforcement mechanics. The supply risk premium continues to compress, with Brent now meaningfully below the $115 highs recorded in late March.

TALKS STATUS	Second round arranging · Both sides propose enrichment pause
REMAINING GAP	Timeframe of pause · Facility dismantling · Hormuz reopening
BLOCKADE	Fully implemented · Iranian port trade halted
OIL RESPONSE	Brent ~$95 · ↓3% Tue · Below $115 late-March highs
DEADLINE	Two-week framework expires ~April 21

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. The January all-time high at 7,002 on the S&P 500 index is today's technical test. With SPY closing at $694.46 and futures hovering near $700, the index is within approximately one session's typical range of a new record. On Carson's framework, all published resistance is now behind. The path to all-time highs is clear barring a negative catalyst. Historically, breakouts to new highs tend to see follow-through when supported by positive earnings surprises and declining volatility—both conditions are currently in place. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

2. Bank earnings continue today with BlackRock, Bank of America, Morgan Stanley, and US Bancorp. The Tuesday setup from JPM and Citi frames expectations: trading revenues and banking fees are strong, but NII guidance remains the key variable. BAC reports before open; BLK reports before open; MS reports today as well. Healthcare giant UnitedHealth (UNH) reports today. IOWN's financial exposure is through SYF (+2.39% Tuesday), which will benefit from the same consumer credit resilience visible in the big-bank Q1 prints. **The physical world matters.**

3. NY Empire State Manufacturing printed 11 vs –0.5 consensus. The manufacturing surge in the April release is the strongest since November 2025 and suggests that production activity is accelerating despite the war-era input cost pressure. This is constructive for IOWN's industrial sleeve: CAT ($794.25 Tuesday, +0.32%), STLD (roughly flat), and FAST (–2.58% on continued Monday miss fallout). The NAHB Housing Market Index at 10 AM ET and EIA crude inventories at 10:30 AM ET round out today's data. Fed Barr speaks at 8:30 AM ET. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

4. The digital sleeve extended gains across the board. HOOD surged 10.35% to $79.09 on momentum following its $1.5 billion buyback authorization and Treasury partnership reports. COIN rallied 5.66%, HUT gained 2.84%, BTC consolidated near $74,000. Morgan Stanley's MSBT spot Bitcoin ETF launch remains pending. The sleeve has fully recovered the Clarity Act-driven damage from late March and is now trading at or near session highs across most names. *Think Like an Owner.*

5. Gold and silver rallied alongside equities — the second cross-asset alignment of the month. GLD rose 2.23% with gold spot near $4,895 and SLV surged 5.51% on Tuesday even as the broad tape ripped higher. The simultaneous rally confirms that the forced-liquidation dynamics that dominated gold during the war's first weeks have fully exhausted. IOWN's gold miners participated: GFI +2.37%, AEM +1.18%. With J.P. Morgan maintaining a year-end target of $6,300 and central bank accumulation ongoing, the precious metals sleeve remains structurally intact even through the ceasefire rally. **Avoid Erosion.**

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